

Close redesign working session

9:00–9:30 Welcome and goals

9:30–10:30 Where the close loses time

10:30–11:30 Target operating model

11:30–12:15 Wave plan and owners

12:15–1:00 Decisions and next steps

OUTCOME

One agreed wave 1 scope and a named owner for each entity.



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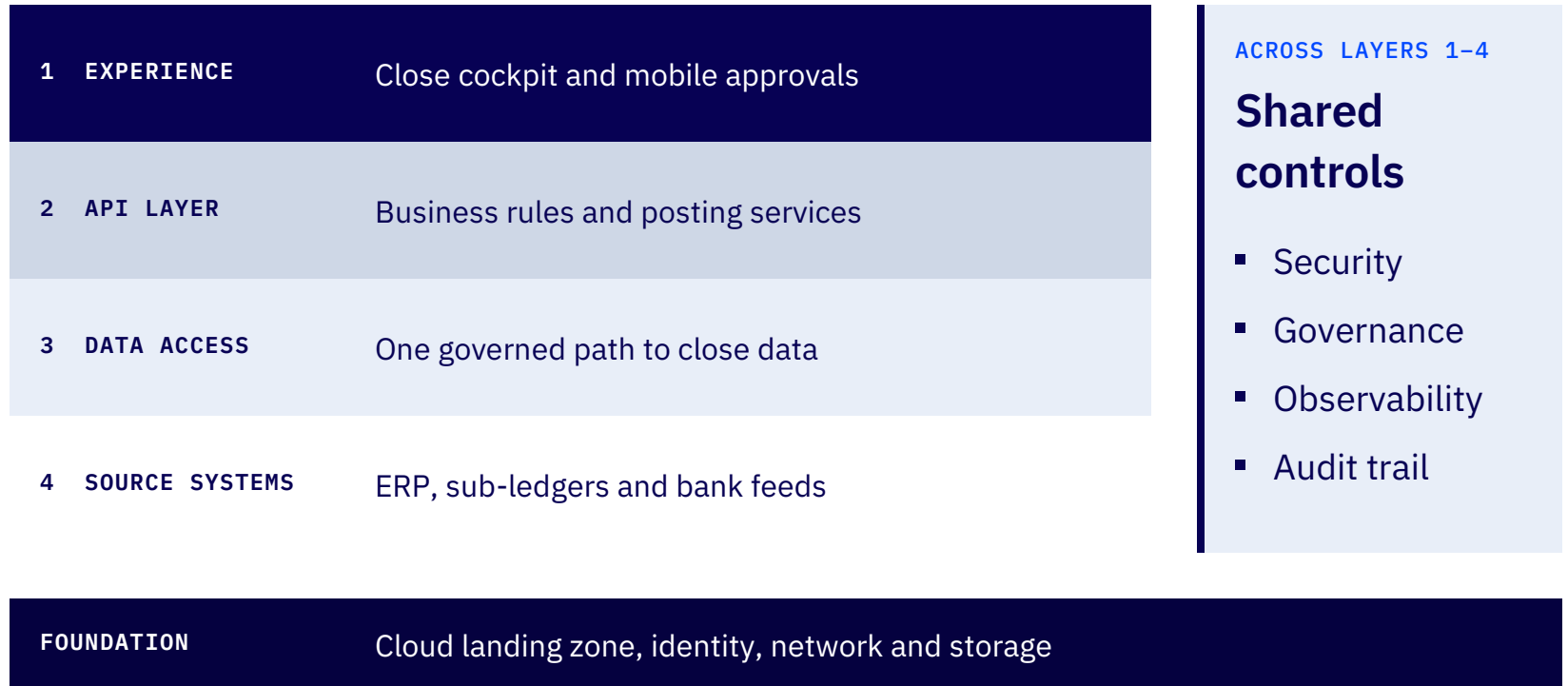


One layered platform replaces the old close tools

CLOSE PLATFORM

Build once

Each layer serves every close process, so one moves without a rebuild.



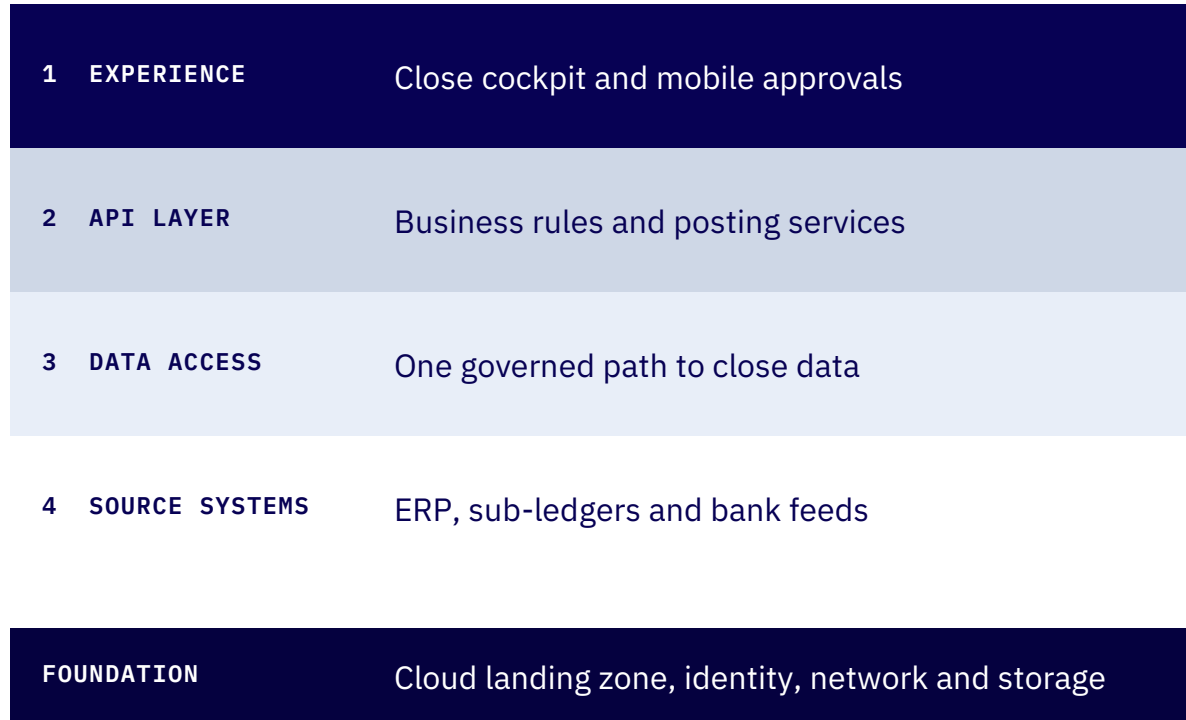
Source: West Monroe reference architecture.

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Each layer serves every close process, so one moves without a rebuild.



ACROSS LAYERS 1-4

Shared controls

- Security
- Governance
- Observability
- Audit trail

Source: West Monroe reference architecture.

OUR DIFFERENCE

You will feel the difference in how we work

Our cross-functional teams combine hands-on finance, data and change experience with the technical depth to solve the whole problem.

We work alongside your team as player-coaches, moving from architecture and guardrails through engineering and operations to go-live.

HANDOVER TARGET

Day 90

Your team runs the platform.

OTHER FIRMS

- One-time benefit capture
- Technology-focused
- Generic blueprint
- Siloed workstreams
- Vendor-led delivery

HOW WE WORK

- Iterative path to go-live
- Platform-product focus
- Integrated architecture
- Player-coach partnership
- Cross-discipline teams

WHAT THAT MEANS FOR YOU



We build the capability to own, run and evolve the platform.



We apply data, cloud, security and change expertise.



We set measurable goals for speed, adoption and cost.



Cross-functional teams work together through delivery.



We target go-live outcomes, not only fixed scope.



Healthcare payer and platform experience shapes decisions.

ALTERNATE EXAMPLE

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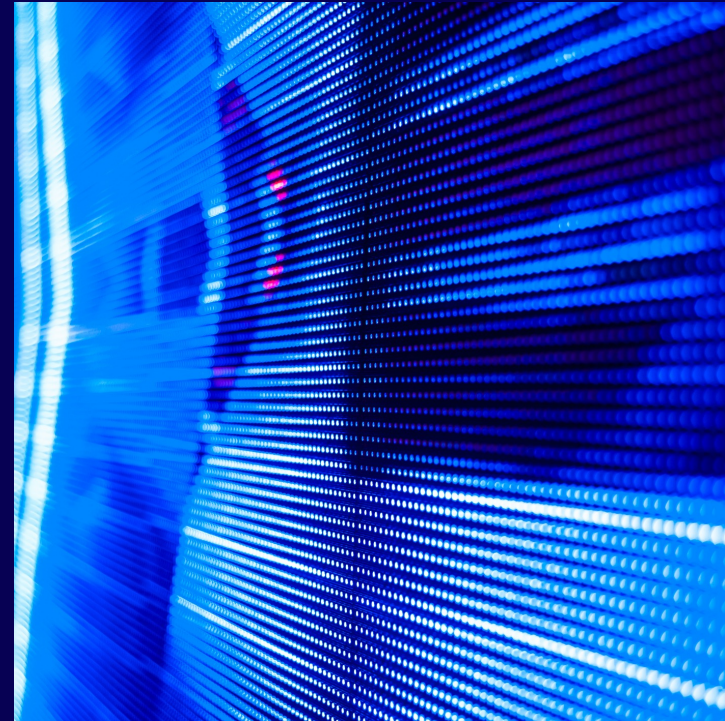
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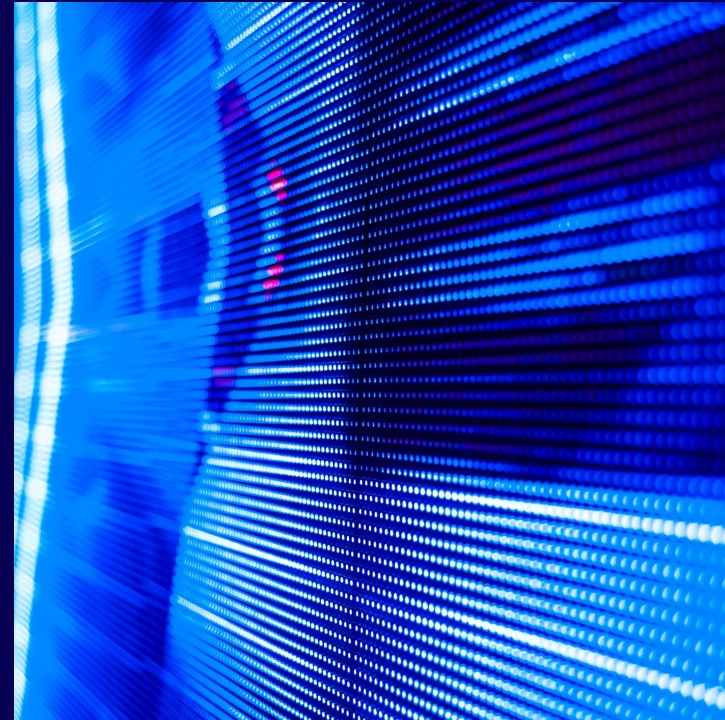
SECTION 05 • TEAM

Who you will work with



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Who you will work with



Select one opportunity to anchor the day

GOAL

Choose one participant-owned, full-stack opportunity that is valuable enough for Product and feasible enough for Engineering to advance today.

1 opportunity by 10:00

STEPS TO GET THERE

15 MIN

01 Frame the candidates

Product shares up to three candidates with evidence.

Output: a shortlist with evidence.

Facilitator: clarify the decision criteria and keep the group out of solution mode.

25 MIN

02 Stress-test together

Engineering tests technical meaning, touchpoints, constraints and a path.

Output: constraints and a path for each.

Facilitator: compare value, feasibility and full-stack depth.

20 MIN

03 Decide and document

The group picks one opportunity and records the rationale.

Output: one opportunity and its rationale.

Facilitator: resolve or assign open questions, then confirm the gate.

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Close the books in **5 days** instead of 12

**We standardize reconciliations,
automate intercompany matching and
move review earlier.**

The controller signs off on day five, and the team stops finding problems on day nine.

\$4.2M

run-rate savings

12 → 5 days

Close the books in 6 days instead of 12

**We standardize reconciliations,
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\$3.8M

run-rate savings

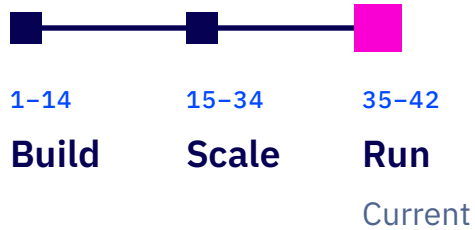
12 → 6 days

APPROACH

Phase 3 hands platform ownership to the Northfield team

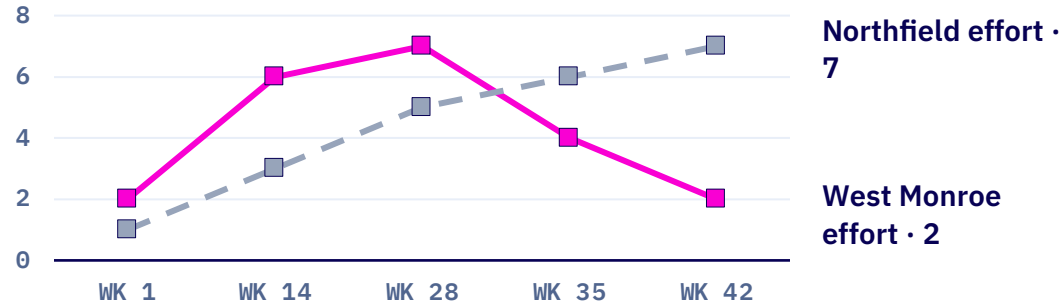
PHASE 03 · WEEKS 35-42

General availability and optimization



EXIT CRITERIA

- Runbooks accepted
- Northfield on call
- Benefits tracked
- Risks transferred



West Monroe tapers its driving role so the Northfield core team owns execution. Effort crosses at about week 30, when Northfield staff lead more work than West Monroe.

Phase 2 · Scalability and early adoption

Phase 3 · General availability

West Monroe team

Deploying provisioning and monitoring, and onboarding the first business units.

Optimizing performance, cost and adoption while transferring ownership and operations.

Northfield team

Refining standards and overseeing the early adopter program.

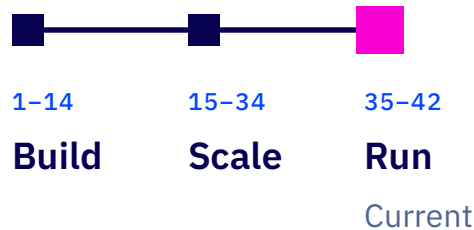
Dedicated staff are learning to support the platform and beginning to lead.

ALTERNATE EXAMPLE

Phase 3 hands platform ownership to the Lakeview team

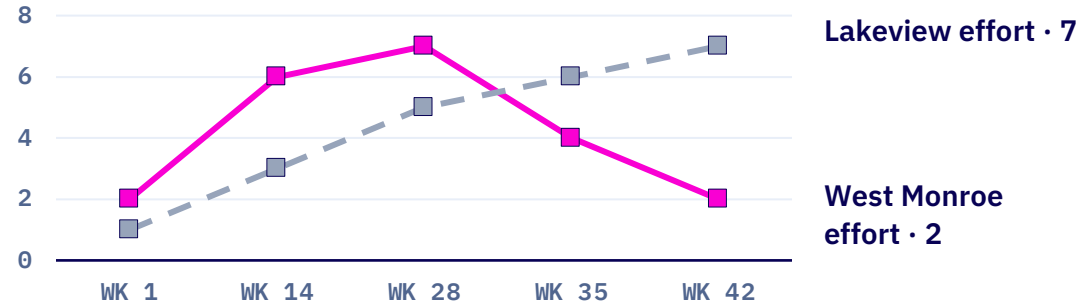
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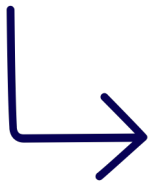
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AI-powered modernization compresses time and risk



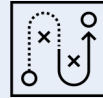
Value first

- We rank work by business value, not technical elegance.
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- Return comes first.



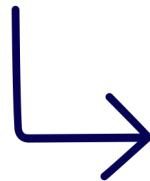
WHY THIS MATTERS

Effort goes where return is highest, so promised value actually lands.



Purpose built

- We choose retain, replatform, rewrite or retire per system.
- Stable components stay in place.
- Nothing is rebuilt for show.



WHY THIS MATTERS

We design around your portfolio, keeping what works and replacing only what drives value.



AI accelerated

- Agents scan and map codebases at scale.
- Evidence, planning and tooling stay connected.
- Months of analysis take days.



WHY THIS MATTERS

Analysis that takes months is done in days, with less reliance on tribal knowledge.



Co-build and scale

- Co-sourced teams sit with your stakeholders.
- Onshore and nearshore flex with demand.
- Knowledge transfer is built in.



WHY THIS MATTERS

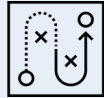
You get capacity without disruption, and a team that can run the result on its own.

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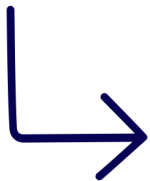
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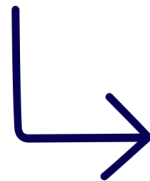
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RISK

Out of the red zone by wave 3

STAY OUT

Labs sit in the red zone

Rules replace manual review.

STAY OUT

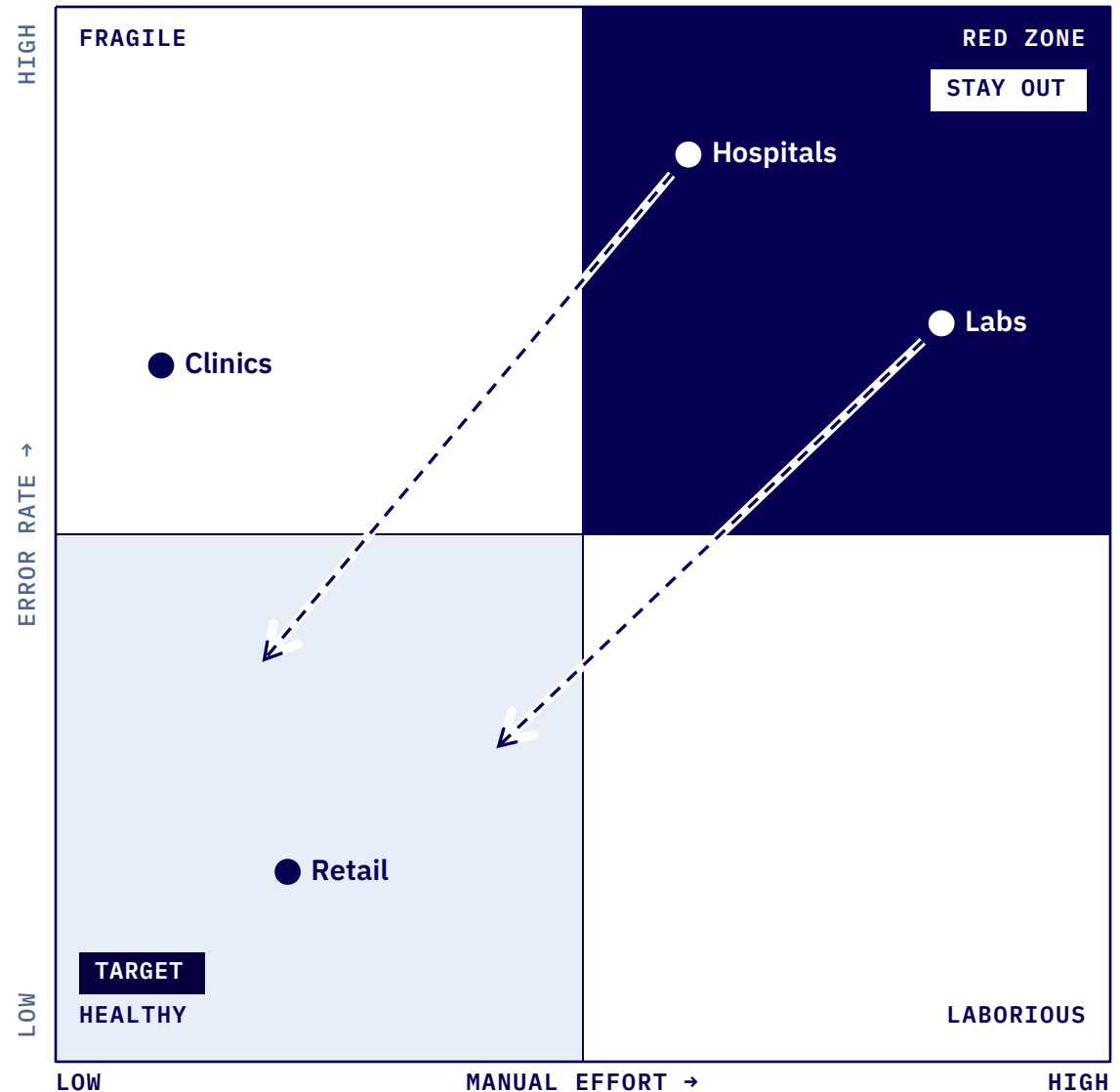
Hospitals follow next

Errors fall with earlier checks.

TARGET

Healthy by wave 3

Clinics and retail hold steady.



Source: Entity error review, 14 units, Aug 2026.

ALTERNATE EXAMPLE

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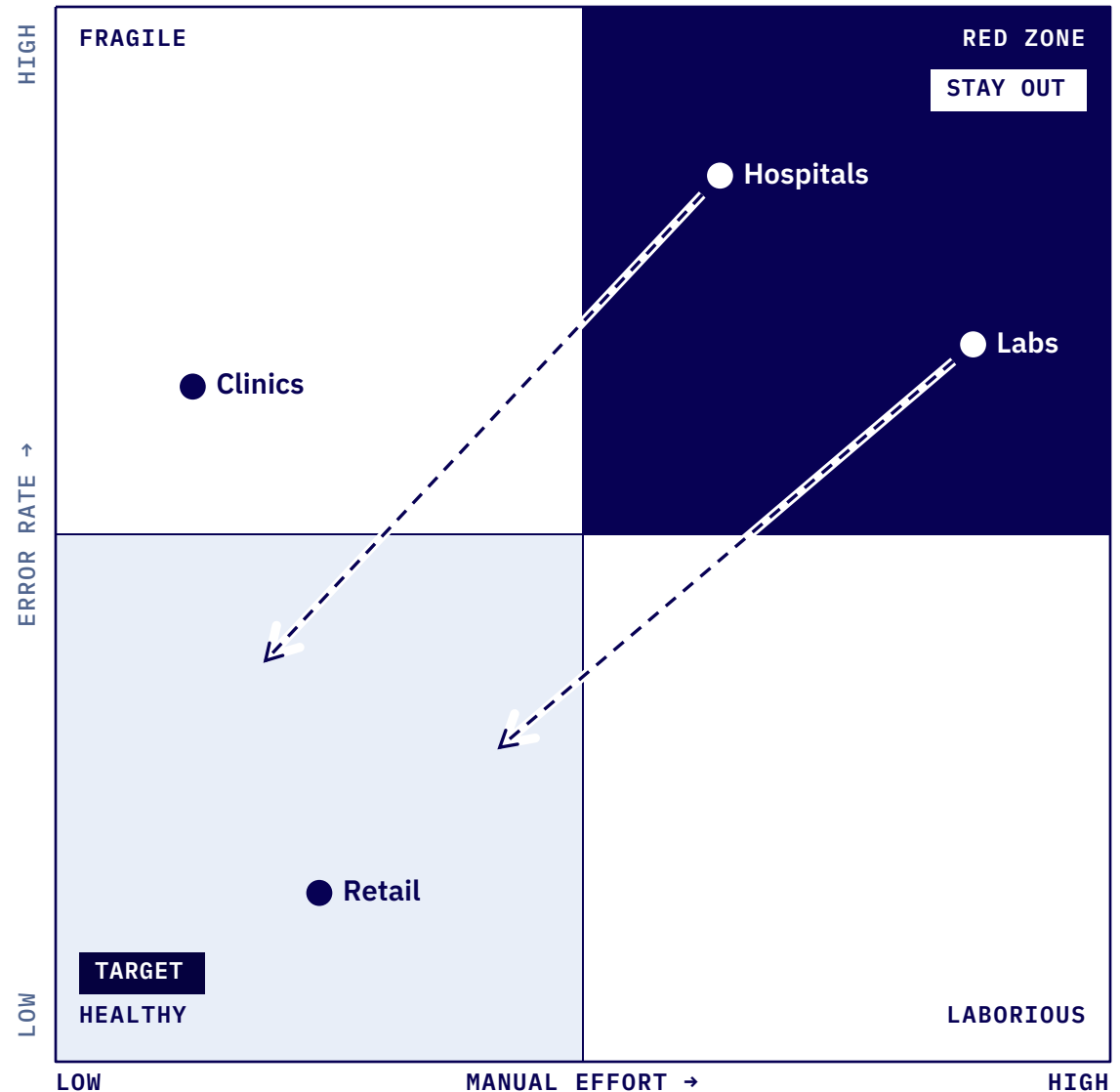
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Healthy by wave 3

Clinics and retail hold steady.



Source: Entity error review, 12 units, Aug 2026.

PRIORITIZATION

Quick wins first: high value, low effort

AIM HERE

Quick wins come first

Three items pay back inside wave 1.

PLAN CAREFULLY

Big bets need a sponsor

High value, but the most effort.

AVOID

Skip the money pits

Cost outruns return on both items.



Source: Northfield finance workshops, Sep 2026.

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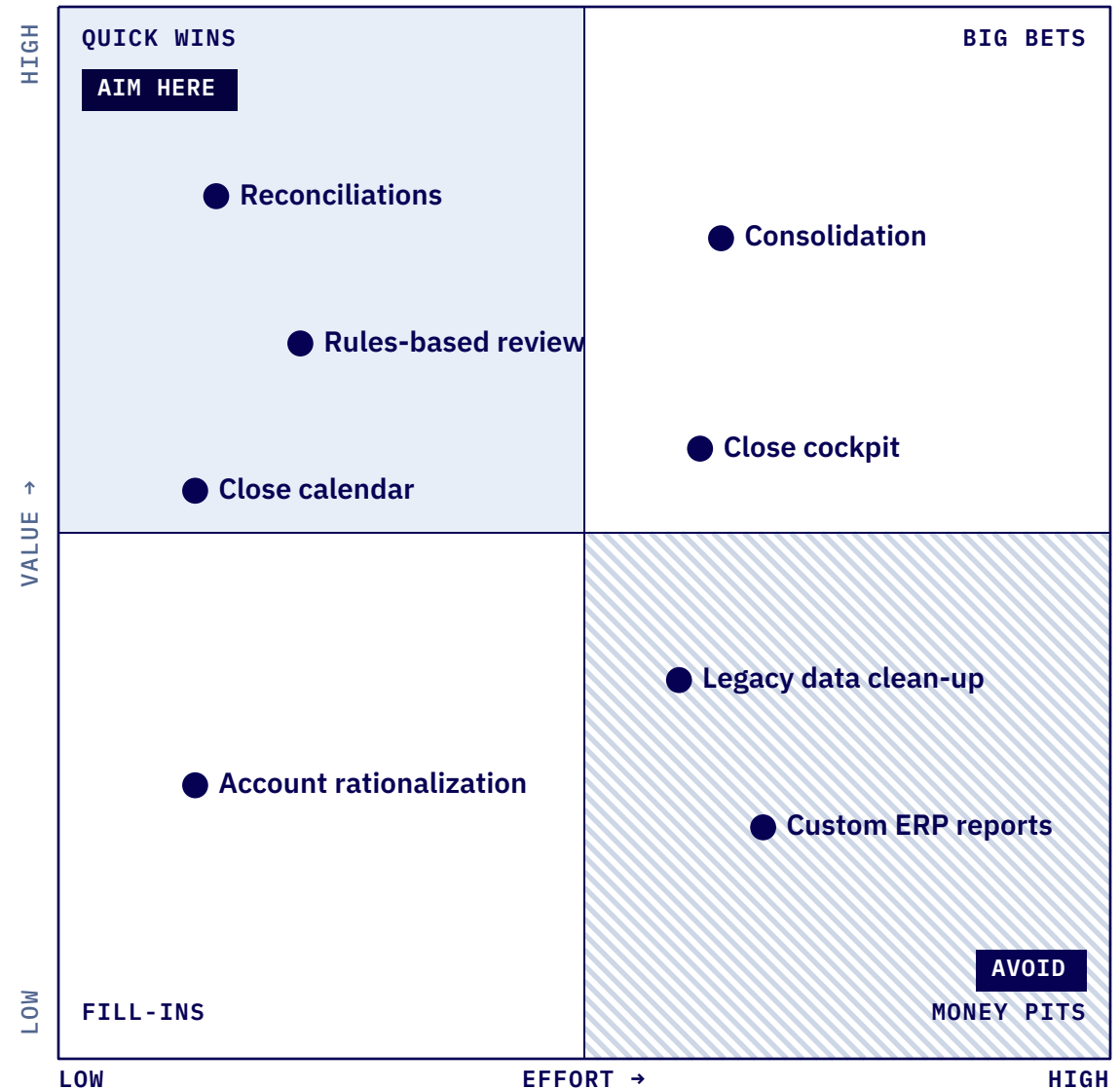
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Expect a facilitated build, not a passive demo

HOW THE SESSION RUNS

-  **Frame together** 15 MIN
Facilitators set the objective and decision criteria; teams bring their own context and constraints.
-  **Work in role** 30 MIN
Product and engineering build in focused tracks; facilitators keep time.
-  **Reconnect at gates** 30 MIN
Teams share artifacts, challenge ambiguity and agree what is ready before the next block.
-  **Iterate and close** 15 MIN
The group reviews evidence, records limits and turns learning into owned next actions.

HOW FACILITATION WORKS

Guide the process without taking over the work

- Short prompts, then participant work
- Named checkpoints and timeboxes
- Active coaching and unblocking
- Human approval at every gate
- Shared notes captured live
- Open risks logged for follow-up

What we need from participants: real context, active decisions, work in progress shared and candor about constraints.

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The program pays for itself within 14 months

\$4.2M

annual run-rate savings

5 days

to close

12 days today

14 mo

to payback

14 business units

WHAT IT MEANS

Faster closes free finance capacity in the first two waves, and that capacity pays for the later work. Cost is recovered in 14 months across all business units.

Source: West Monroe analysis of the FY26 baseline; net of one-time cost.

ALTERNATE EXAMPLE

The program pays for itself within 16 months

\$3.8M

annual run-rate savings

6 days

to close

12 days today

16 mo

to payback

12 business units

WHAT IT MEANS

Faster closes free finance capacity in the first two waves, and that capacity pays for the later work. Cost is recovered in 16 months across all business units.

Source: West Monroe analysis of the FY26 baseline; net of one-time cost.

Northfield closes in 5 days and saves \$4.2M a year

5 days

to close, down from 12

\$4.2M

annual run-rate savings

14

business units on one process

3 waves

to full rollout

WHERE THE SAVINGS COME FROM

Automated matching clears the intercompany balances that today take three people four days each month. Moving review to the point of posting means exceptions are fixed on day one instead of being found on day nine.

Together they remove about 11,000 hours of manual effort a year across the 14 business units, and let the controller sign off on day five without adding headcount.

Source: West Monroe analysis of the FY26 baseline; run-rate after wave 3.

ALTERNATE EXAMPLE

Lakeview closes in 6 days and saves \$3.8M a year

6 days

to close, down from 12

\$3.8M

annual run-rate savings

12

business units on one process

3 waves

to full rollout

RULES REPLACE MANUAL MATCHING

Automated matching clears exceptions daily. Controllers review issues as entries post, with one owner for each exception and a shared six-day close calendar.

The first three waves cover 12 units. Removing repeated checks releases finance capacity and creates a clear audit trail without adding headcount.

Source: West Monroe analysis of the FY26 baseline; run-rate after wave 3.

BUSINESS CASE

The program funds itself by month 14

\$4.2M

run-rate savings from the first two waves

18%

lower cost to serve across 14 units

WHERE THE SAVINGS COME FROM

Automated matching clears intercompany balances every day instead of at period end, which removes most of the manual reconciliation effort. Earlier review moves controller checks to the point of posting, so errors are fixed while they are cheap rather than found on day nine. Together the two changes free controllers to analyze results instead of chasing status.

Source: West Monroe analysis of the FY26 baseline; net of one-time cost.

WHAT THIS MEANS

Start wave 1 in Q1 to reach payback in 2027

Each quarter of delay pushes payback out by about four months.

ALTERNATE EXAMPLE

The program funds itself by month 16

\$3.8M

run-rate savings from the first two waves

18%

lower cost to serve across 12 units

CAPACITY RELEASED THROUGH DAILY REVIEW

Daily matching and earlier review remove repeated reconciliation work. Owners address exceptions as entries post, and controllers use the shared calendar to focus on decisions. The first two waves release capacity for the next phase.

Source: West Monroe analysis of the FY26 baseline; net of one-time cost.

WHAT THIS MEANS

Start wave 1 in Q1 to reach payback in 2028

Each quarter of delay pushes payback out by about four months.

Design general availability in from the start

01 Define the service catalog

ACTIVITIES

- Name the workloads served
- Split central from team services

OUTPUT

Published catalog

02 Set the standards

ACTIVITIES

- Approve patterns per environment
- Agree workload placement rules

OUTPUT

Signed-off standards

03 Industrialize delivery

ACTIVITIES

- Automate provisioning
- Build CI/CD promotion paths

OUTPUT

Release pipeline

04 Drive adoption and ownership

ACTIVITIES

- Open intake and onboarding
- Define the self-service path

OUTPUT

Trained owner teams

05 Prove value and cost

ACTIVITIES

- Baseline cost per workload
- Track savings against plan

OUTPUT

Value report

KEY RISKS IF THE WORK IS NOT DONE RIGHT

The platform becomes an IT silo

It stays a project, not a service

Costs rise faster than usage

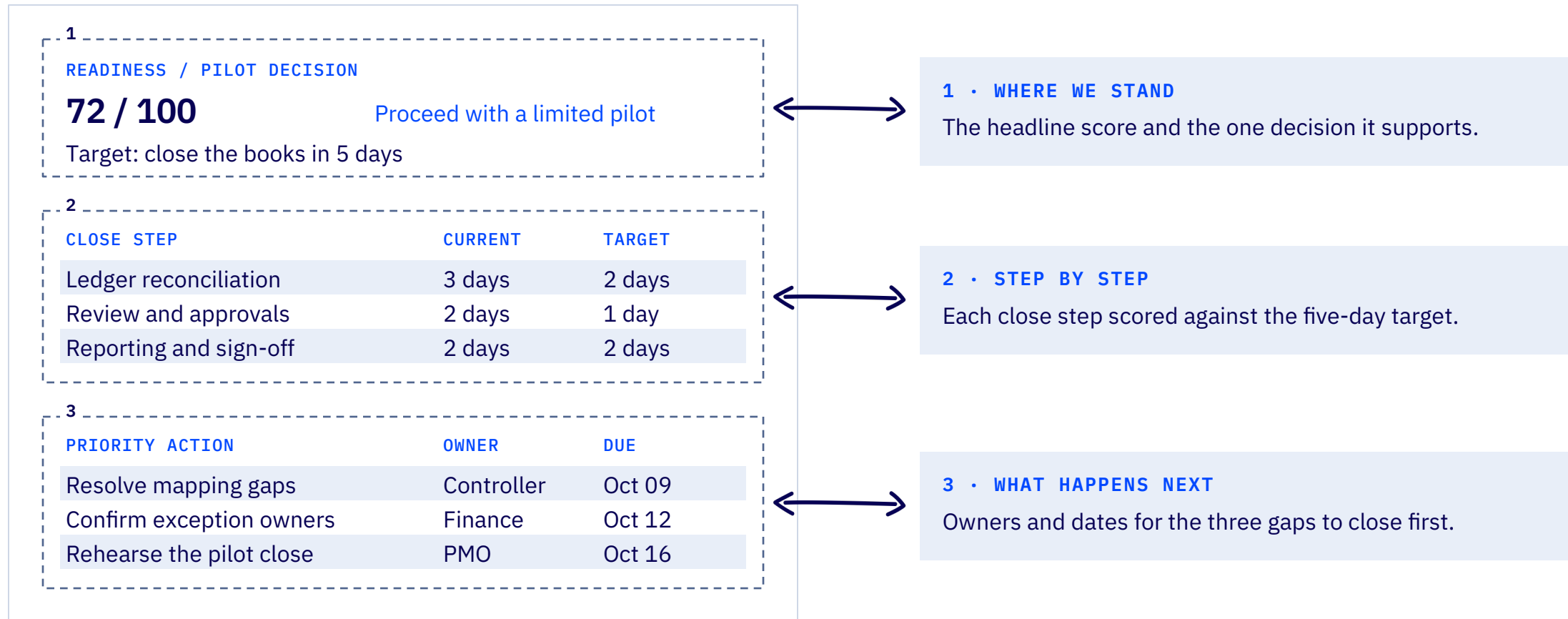
Adoption stalls at capacity limits

Value is never shown to funders

Design general availability in from the start

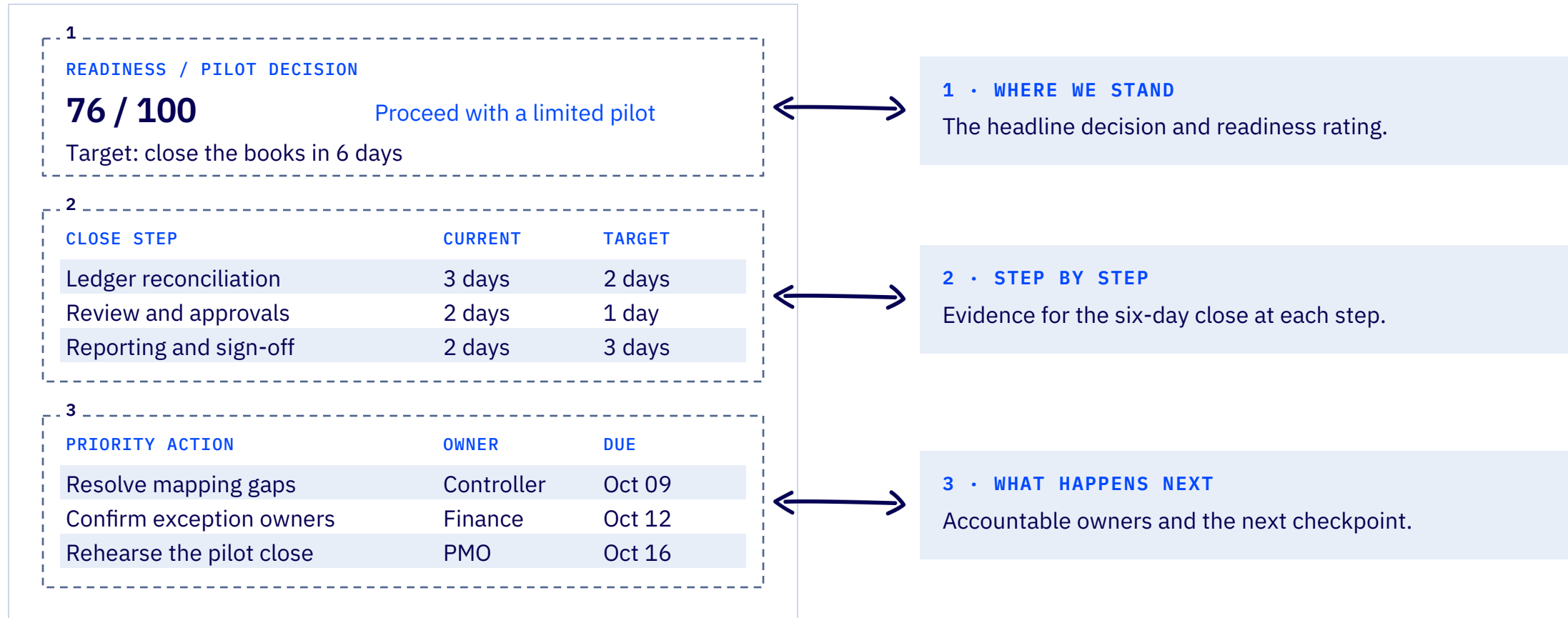
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The platform becomes an IT silo	It stays a project, not a service	Costs rise faster than usage	Adoption stalls at capacity limits	Value is never shown to funders

Each zone of the readiness scorecard has a job



Source: Illustrative page. Final outputs are tailored to Northfield's data and confirmed priorities.

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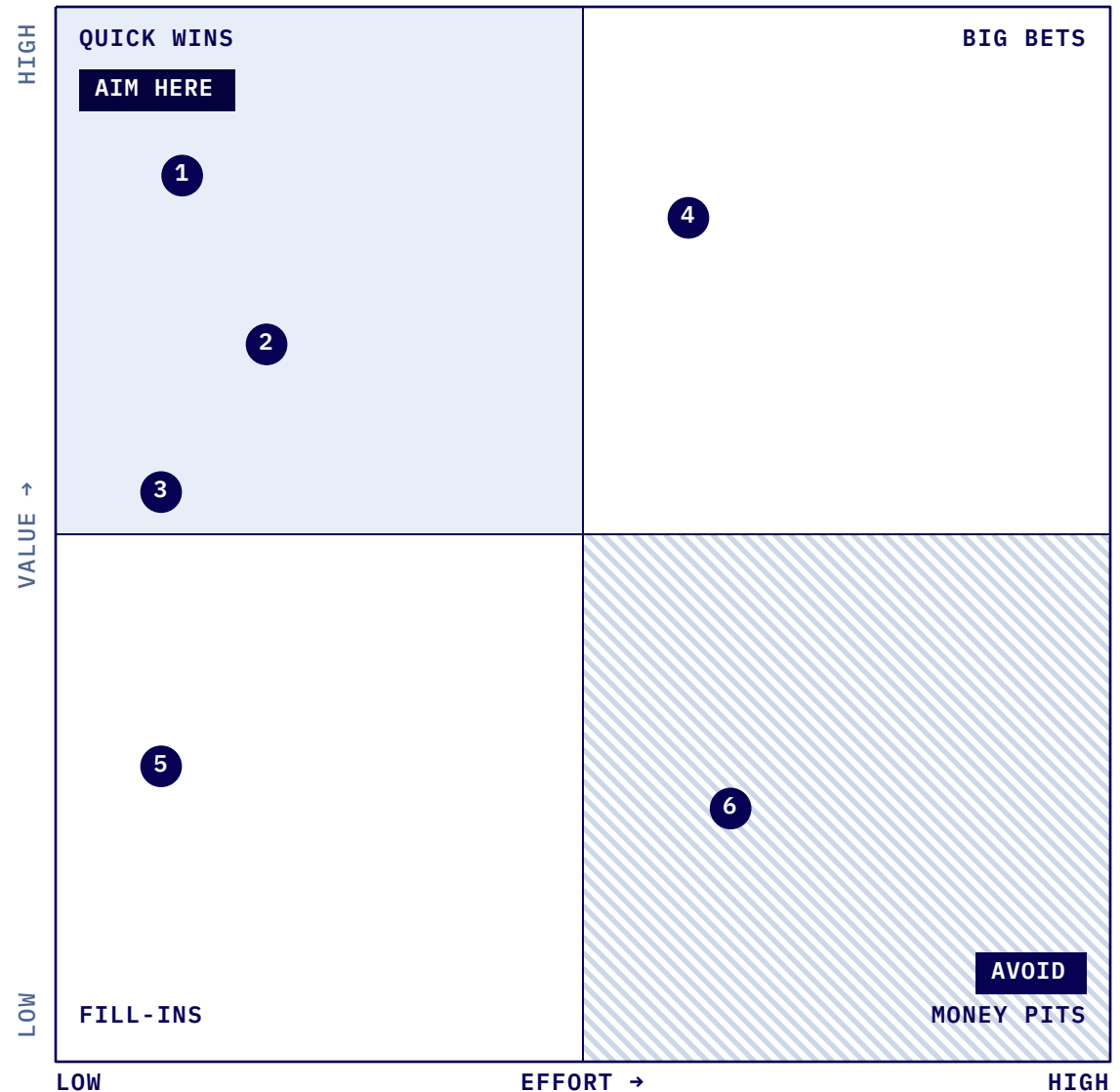


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PRIORITIZATION

Six initiatives, ranked by value and effort

- 01 Reconciliations**
Automated matching, wave 1.
- 02 Rules-based review**
Replaces manual checks.
- 03 Close calendar**
One shared timetable.
- 04 Consolidation**
Highest value, most effort.
- 05 Account rationalization**
Fewer accounts to maintain.
- 06 Custom ERP reports**
Cost outruns the return.

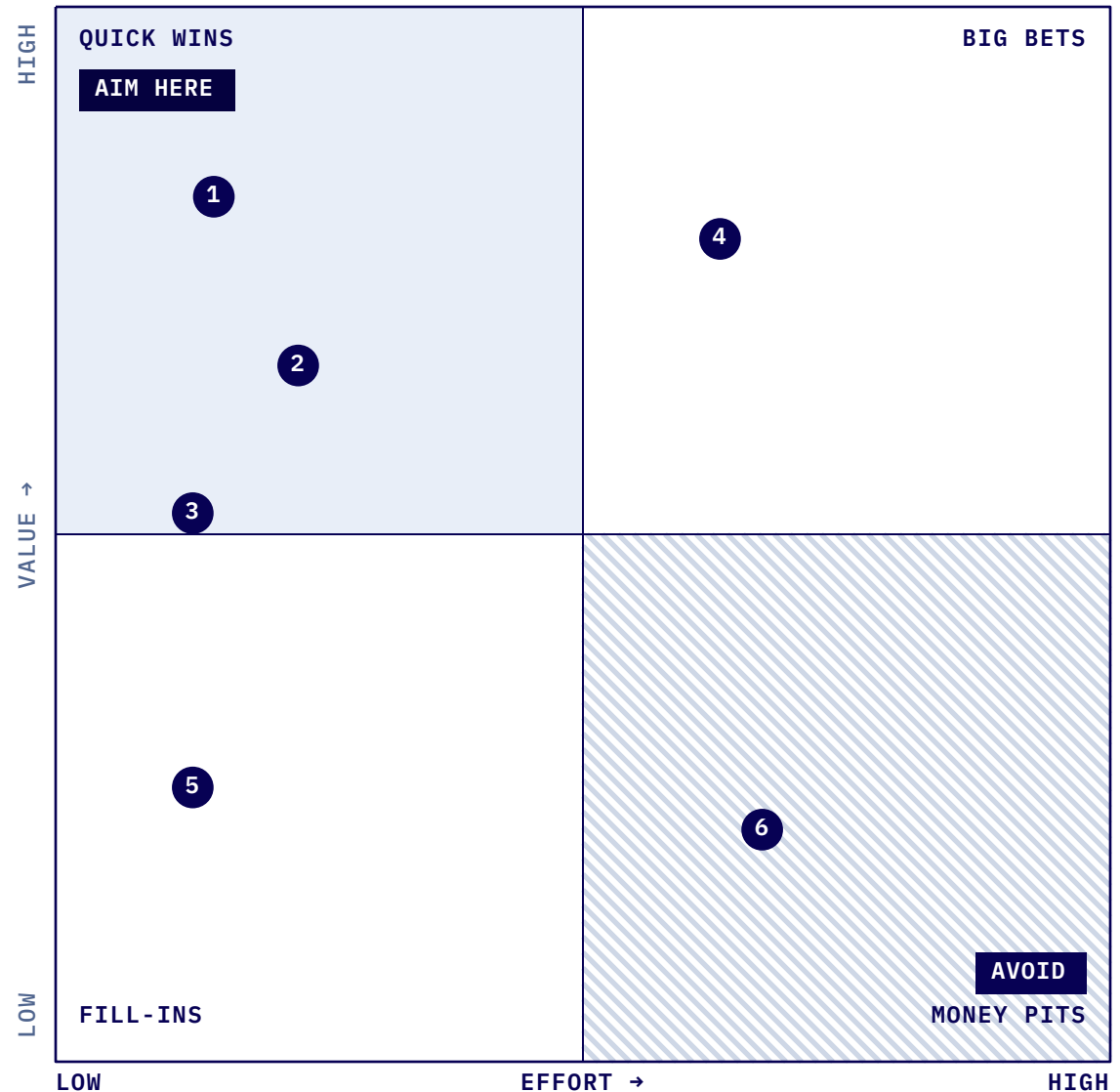


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Tick every reconciliation before step 4 loads balances

STEP 4

Load balances to the new ledger

Load the extracted open balances by entity and prove they match the legacy books.

OWNERS

- Finance IT · executes
- Data lead · reconciles
- Controller · accountable

WINDOW

Fri 22:30 · 2 h

DONE	RECONCILIATION CHECK	LEGACY	TOLERANCE	NEW LEDGER
☐	Row count by entity	412,806	Zero	
☐	Debit and credit totals	\$1.284bn	\$0	
☐	Open items by entity	9,418	±0.1%	
☐	Intercompany balances	\$38.2m	±0.5%	

SUB-STEPS

- Load by entity, parents last
- Run the count and total checks
- Park rejected rows
- Log each variance

ACCEPTANCE

- Every check inside tolerance
- Variances explained and signed
- Data lead releases step 5

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Tick every criterion before step 7 opens the ledger

STEP 7

Hold the go or no-go decision

Review the evidence for every criterion and decide whether the ledger opens to users.

OWNERS

- Cutover lead · decides
- Controller · signs balances
- CIO · endorses

WINDOW

Sat 03:30 · 30 min

GO	GO CRITERION	EVIDENCE	APPROVER
☐	Balances tie to legacy	Reconciliation report	Controller
☐	Interfaces pass end to end	Interface test pack	Integration lead
☐	Rollback fits the window	Timed rollback record	Technical lead
☐	Support bridge staffed	Signed rota	Support lead

IF GO

- Controller opens the ledger
- Support lead sends the notice
- Log the decision and time

IF NO-GO

- Cutover lead invokes rollback
- Escalate to level 3
- Reset the date at steering

ALTERNATE EXAMPLE

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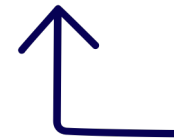
MEASURED CALLOUT

Canonical artwork points to the named target.



Below Right

MEASURED TARGET



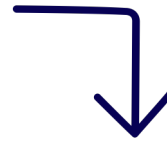
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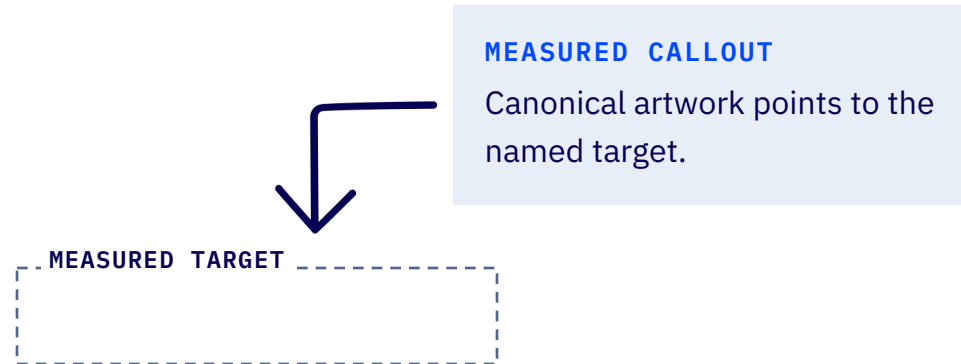
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MEASURED TARGET

Above Right



Left

MEASURED CALLOUT

Canonical artwork points to the named target.



Right

MEASURED CALLOUT

Canonical artwork points to the named target.

MEASURED TARGET



Left Double

MEASURED CALLOUT

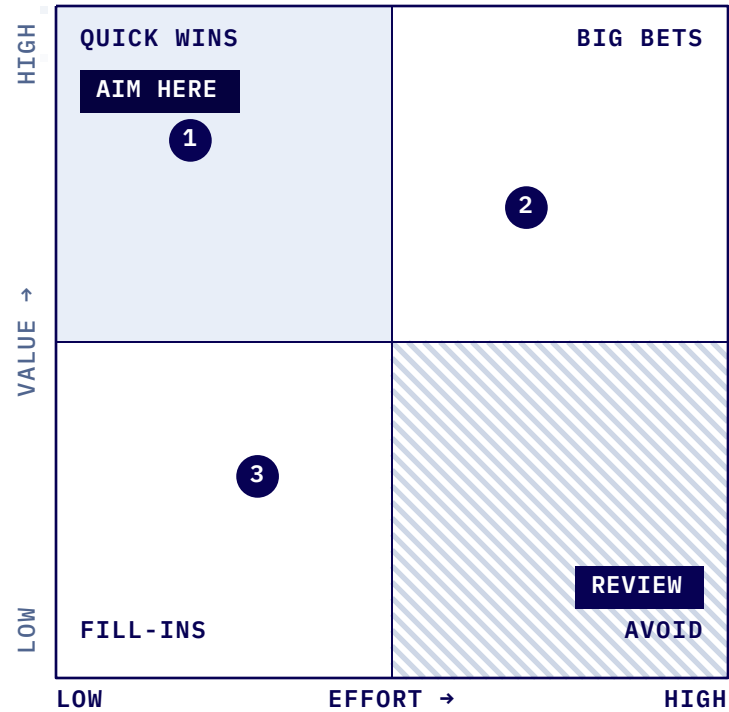
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MEASURED TARGET



Numbered points with an internal legend



- 1 Shared calendar
- 2 Workflow redesign
- 3 Data cleanup